The delayed discussion of compounding and derivation is somewhat disappointingly short, given the richness of the rest of the volume. (Ringe refers the reader to Meid 1967. This indeed has a wealth of information, but it is only accessible in German, which seems to contradict Ringe's desire to slant this volume to a non-specialist reader). The section on compounding addresses the (still incomplete) univerbation of some verbs and preverbs; that on derivational suffixes moves rapidly across numerous noun- and adjective-forming suffixes.

In regard to syntax, Ringe remarks simply that Proto-Germanic "reflected the PIE situation with little change, aside from the development of prepositions" (295), and adds little else. The final section on the Proto-Germanic lexicon provides a helpful list of new lexemes of doubtful or unknown origin, as well as the several borrowings from Celtic and Latin and the less-than-handful from more eastern languages.

The 49-page index lists reconstructed forms in PIE, Proto-Germanic, Proto-West-Germanic, Proto-Celtic, and a wide variety of attested languages. Annoyingly, there is no subject index. The table of contents is extremely detailed, which certainly supplies some of that need. But for a reader who would like to check references on the Caland system or Lindeman's law or the aorist, there is no recourse.

Overall, this book is a masterful achievement. Ringe sets the reader securely in the reconstructed grammar of PIE, then moves in an orderly and coherent fashion to arrive at the reconstructed grammar of Proto-Germanic. As always, the trip is as important as the destination. Ringe often provides competing reconstructions, followed either by a convincing argument in favor of one of them, or an admission that the reality remains murky. He consistently illustrates his points with a vast wealth of detail. His prose is lucid and accessible. This book not only fills a gap in the literature, but does so with confidence, vigor and style. I look forward to the next installment in this series.

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Lisi Oliver
Department of English/Interdepartmental Program in Linguistics
Louisiana State University
lolivel@lsu.edu

Hartmann, Markus. 2005. *Die frühlateinischen Inschriften und ihre Datierung. Eine linguistisch-archäologisch-paläographische Untersuchung.* Bremen: Hempen Verlag. xiv + 466 pp. €60hb.

Among the countless corollaries of Murphy's Law is one that is sorely regretted by every historian of the Latin language: *Those documents most capable of shedding light on the early history of Latin—the Archaic Latin inscriptions—are precisely the ones that cannot be dated with precision.* In this published version of his Würzburg dissertation, Markus Hartmann sets out to address this grievous situation by providing a strict methodology for arriving at more accurate datings of the earliest Latin inscriptions, a methodology which he then applies, with promising results and (whatever one thinks of his specific proposals) accompanied by a great deal of interesting discussion. This is therefore a work of signal importance, both for Latin epigraphy and for the history of Latin in general.

After a brief exposition of the problem, Hartmann begins with a survey and justification of early texts (mostly fragmentary) that he has excluded from his corpus (5-35). A noteworthy item here, and one that illustrates both the rigor of his approach and some of its limitations, is his exclusion of the so-called "Tita Vendia Inscription" (29-33), a text from the 7th or 6th century BC:

ECOVRNATITAVENDIASMAMAR[----------
]ḆḌḞḤḆ///

This text, assigned to Faliscan by some, but now usually considered to be Latin, presents a number of difficulties, not least of all arising from the missing portions of the text (i.e., the bracketed section and the material at the end indicated by "///"). Hartmann points out (32) that several of the letter forms are foreign to Archaic Faliscan writing, such as the <H> with horizontal cross-stroke, and that the apparent use of <FH> to express [f] is a marked early Latin feature. That judgment, however, depends on the traditional reading (as above) and on the standard interpretation of the sequence in question, i.e. [M]EDFHE[KED] or [M]EDFHE[CED] 'made me' (~ Class. Lat. *me fecit*). Hartmann then observes that fully four of the nine letters in that sequence are conjectural, and that other readings of the five extant letters (all of them fragmentary) have been proposed, namely]EREHA[and]NDFEI[. This is where Hartmann leaves the matter; but not all conjectures are equal. Apart from a suggestion about the <D>, to be mentioned shortly, Hartmann does not comment on whether Pallottino's reading]EREHA[or Pisani's]NDFEI[is superior or inferior to the standard transcription]EDFHE[, or even whether any reasonable sense can be extracted from]EREHA[or]NDFEI[, as opposed to the excellent sense—appropriate in all respects—of Peruzzi's [M]EDFHE[KED]. Again and again, Hartmann raises valid points that inject an element of doubt into the received wisdom about these extremely difficult texts, and his ultra-skeptical approach is on the whole salutary. Yet often, as here, he fails to pursue further analysis that might clarify the situation; and on occasion, as with his hypothetical attempt to see a Faliscan-style <F> in the <D> of]EDFHE[(32-33), his skepticism merely muddies the waters even further, with little gain.[1] When the paleographical discussion is accompanied, as it sometimes is, by incomplete linguistic analysis, one is left wondering what has actually been accomplished by this extreme skepticism.[2]

Having justified his exclusions, Hartmann proceeds to a detailed presentation of his corpus of the earliest Latin inscriptions (36-170), each text accompanied by lavish documentation, usually including multiple photographs and facsimiles—an extremely valuable and well-crafted feature of the book. The usual suspects are here (the Forum Inscription, the Duenos Inscription, the Lapis Satricanus, and others, a dozen in all), and in most cases, the material is familiar. But there are two important surprises, both accorded lengthy and penetrating treatments. The seven-letter so-called "Vetusia-inscription"—a 7th-century BC text both in traditional estimations and in Hartmann's new chronology—is minutely investigated (37-66): Hartmann demonstrates that the view identifying this inscription as Etruscan is not likely to be correct, and that the text should instead be considered Latin (as many have also assumed). The demonstration is convincing, even if one cannot follow Hartmann on all points.[3] Still

[1] Another example, among many: in an otherwise useful discussion of inverted <V> (410-421), Hartmann adduces CIL I^2 2903e (418), and is content to observe that in addition to a possible reading *M. Veio(s)*, with inverted <V> (Vine 1993:88), the text can also be read as *M. Peio(s), M. Teio(s), M. Leio(s),* or *M. M(?)eio(s).* The absence of any further evaluation renders this an exasperatingly superficial treatment: in fact, *Peio(s)* corresponds to no known name; Hartmann's *M(?)eio(s),* which no one has ever suggested, is highly dubious for a variety of reasons (as his own question mark implies); and so on.

[2] Here, for example, Hartmann's linguistic analysis (33, similarly 65) operates with the widely-held assumption that TITAVENDIAS forms a two-part naming expression, with TITA as *praenomen,* despite the apparent mismatch in the case forms of TITA and VENDIAS. Though he references other interpretations (from the 1950's and 1960's, including Giacomelli 1963:261; but see now also Watkins 1995:129, following Giacomelli), he does not consider them, even though they seriously undermine the traditional interpretation of this sequence.

[3] In assessing the phonological and morphological background of *Vetusia*, in Latin (as opposed to Etruscan) terms, beside the Latin gentilicium *Veturius* (cited by Livy in the pre-rhotacized form *Vetusius*), Hartmann begins (65) by accepting the *communis opinio* that Lat. *vetus* 'old' goes back to a PIE neuter *s*-stem **u̯et-es-* 'year', comparable to Gk. (ϝ)ετος 'id.' The reality is much more complex, readily inferable from the tortured argumentation of

more dramatic is Hartmann's reconsideration of the problems surrounding the Praenestine Fibula (67-106), now often asserted to be a forgery. Hartmann reaffirms the probable genuineness of the inscription, at least pending additional evidence, as well as its Latin character, and I find his arguments persuasive, though there is no space here to rehearse the particulars. It suffices to say that with these two substantial discussions, the landscape of early Latin inscriptions appears in a somewhat new light, given Hartmann's defense of the Vetusia-inscription and of the Praenestine Fibula as the two oldest Latin texts, both dating to the 7th century BC.

The heart of the book is the extraordinarily detailed consideration of dating based on paleography (220-425, of which 290-402 consist largely of tables, charting comparative paleographical data from the inscriptions in Hartmann's corpus, as well as in three somewhat later texts used as *Gegenproben*, i.e. as experimental controls). In the face of the traditional pessimism about the reliability of paleographical criteria for dating, Hartmann's major innovation is the idea of considering, in a highly systematic fashion, not the appearance of individual letter forms in particular texts, but rather the full constellation of the letter forms (and other paleographic features) in each text, as compared with each other text in the corpus. In charting these data, Hartmann tabulates all relevant distinctions for each letter: thus for <O>, he considers, for each text, whether it appears as large (as in the Garigliano Bowl Inscription), small (as in most other texts in the corpus, and *also* on the Garigliano Bowl), round (as in most texts), angular (as in CIL I^2 474), closed (as in most texts, including the Garigliano Bowl), open (as also on the Garigliano Bowl and CIL I^2 479), or notated as a punctum (as in the Tibur Pedestal Inscription). He also charts a series of relevant orthographic practices, such as the direction of writing and the nature of the punctuation, as well as (much more voluminously) patterns related to individual letters: e.g. the use of <FH> for [f] (cf. above), the use of <G> (as opposed to <C> or <Q>) for [g], etc.; and among these, special interest attaches to patterns involving the so-called "C/K/Q-convention," more on which below. All of this allows Hartmann to do two things: first, to provide a full description of every relevant paleographical feature of each inscription in his corpus; and secondly, to use these data for calculating the paleographical similarity or divergence of each inscription as compared with each other inscription. It is on the basis of these calculations (discussed 403-09) that Hartmann arrives at his dating proposals for the inscriptions in question (426-34), using as a control whatever rough dating information is available from the archaeological record (charted at 432).

In truth, Hartmann's results differ little from previous mainstream estimations. The most marked outcome is perhaps the exclusion of certain late datings no longer taken seriously by most specialists anyway, such as the late dating of the Forum Inscription (CIL I^2 1, a text of the 7th-6th centuries BC in Hartmann's view, and in that of many others) or the late dating of the Duenos Inscription (CIL I^2 4, placed by Hartmann and others in the first half of the 6th century BC). And for the one inscription this reader, at least, most fervently hoped would benefit from Hartmann's technique—the Tibur Pedestal Inscription (CIL I^2 2658)—his method in the end proves unable to cope with the relative brevity of the text, its unusual lettering, and the strong possibility of influence from non-Latin writing traditions. Yet even here,

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Stüber (2002:187-88; not cited by Hartmann), in her own attempt to defend this view. Hartmann's suggestion that the unexpected *u*-vocalism of *Veturius* (vs. expected **Veterius*) could be due to influence from *s*-stem adjectival derivatives with /-u-/ of the type *venustus, onustus* (he might also have mentioned *vetustus* and the abstract *vetustas*) seems possible, though the absence of parallels is somewhat troubling (e.g. *onus/oneris, onustus,* but †*onurius*; *augurius* is not quite comparable). But in any event, this explanation would apply only to *Veturius,* since the /-u-/ of forms like *onustus* results from medial vowel-weakening, which postdates the form *Vetusia*; and we are not told how these considerations might help interpret the /-u-/ of *Vetusia.* In fact, *vetus* as an inherited *s*-stem poses severe difficulties, and Nussbaum (1986:145, n.15) may be correct in suggesting an old *u*-stem source **u̯et-u-* (whence *s*-stem **u̯et-u-s-*, cf. the type Ved. *tápu-* 'hot' ~ *tápuṣ-* 'heat'), with possible support in Baltic and Slavic—and also, one wonders, in OLat. *Vetusia.*

Hartmann brings new clarity: though the chronological window within which the text could have been written remains somewhat large, Hartmann's concluding discussion (432-33) sets the parameters of our inability to date the text, and does so with an exactitude that may yet prove valuable. In a similar way, even if Hartmann's other datings hardly differ from the *communis opinio,* the rigor of his methodology provides welcome support and establishes a new standard for future investigations.

One wishes, in fact, that Hartmann had pushed some of his paleographical analyses a bit further. Thus, for the Forum Inscription (122-30, 252-56), he duly notes the boustrophedon writing (one of the *Schriftrichtung* features carefully charted in his tables), but never mentions its most salient aspect in this text, namely the odd "inverted" lines, which break the normal flow of the boustrophedon format at several points. This has usually been seen as a blunder (or, rather, at least two of them) on the part of the stonecutter (e.g. Gordon 1983:79; Wachter 1987:68-69). My own alternative suggestion (Vine 1993:37-50) took this to be a regular feature related to the paragraph-structure of the text, perhaps comparable (Vine 1993:49-50) to the Etruscan text known as the Capua Tile (TLE 2, ET II), with horizontal lines separating paragraphs and directional breaks in the boustrophedon writing in the transition to some paragraphs. The comparison with this Etruscan text (of about the 5th century BC) is noteworthy, in light of Hartmann's discussion of the C/K/Q-convention, a marked feature of the Forum Inscription—and of no other early Latin text (note Hartmann's important discussion of this point, 424-25)—which Hartmann takes to be chronologically significant, given the same practice in Southern Etruscan writing from the 7th-5th centuries BC (253-54, 432, n.395). One also misses some discussion of the small size of the data sets involved in Hartmann's calculations: although his percentages attempt to adjust for this in certain ways, the limited number of tokens raises questions about statistical validity that should at least have been acknowledged. Finally, among more substantive points, one wonders why Hartmann's brief treatment of "linguistic dating" (214-19) has nothing to say about medial vowel-weakening, normally assumed to have begun around the 5th or 4th century BC, and therefore of some interest for forms like IOVESAT (not †IOVISAT) in the Duenos Inscription, FHE: FHAKED (not †FHE:FHIKED) in the Praenestine Fibula, etc. But Hartmann writes (3) that the entire book is in effect a pilot project for a "chronology of Latin sound laws," where, one imagines, such discussions might find their place.

Not surprisingly for a book of this richness, one may also quibble with smaller points here and there;[4] and one may especially regret certain features of its presentation. Hartmann's exposition, as with many such unrevised (or nearly-unrevised) dissertations, frequently annoys through its *longueurs.*[5] Yet none of these reservations should obscure the importance of what Hartmann has achieved in this very welcome, extraordinarily well-documented, and in many ways highly-accomplished study.

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[4] E.g.: Hartmann follows Leumann (1977:228) in dating the loss of *–d* after long vowel to around 200 BC (217, cf. his application of this datum at 215), apparently ignoring Porzio Gernia 1974 (not cited in his otherwise opulent bibliography) and many of the discussions of Wachter 1987, suggesting that this had taken place some decades earlier; his supposition that the verb form IOVESAT in the Duenos Inscription is chronologically without value since its unrhotacized <S> could reflect an archaizing spelling (216) is unlikely in the extreme; etc.

[5] E.g.: In a work of this sort clearly addressed to a specialist audience, there was no need to provide translations of Latin and Italian quotations (many quite lengthy), a practice Hartmann eventually discontinues later in the book; Hartmann advises the reader that he will not retail any number of outmoded theories (36)—for which one is grateful—yet he needlessly surveys the obsolete readings of the Tibur Pedestal Inscription that predate Vetter's discovery of its serpentine writing (133-34); etc.

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Brent Vine
Department of Classics/
Program in Indo-European Studies
UCLA
vine@humnet.ucla.edu

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